HOME EMERGENCY KIT

What to keep at home to get through two weeks without power, water or stores, and what to look for when you buy it.

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GUIDE / VERIFY: General preparedness information, not a substitute for professional advice, local emergency-management instructions or manufacturer directions. Needs differ by household and location. **Verify important information with current official sources before relying on it.**

Keep the kit together in one place everyone knows (a closet, a shelf, a couple of plastic bins). Check it twice a year; changing the clocks for daylight saving time is an easy reminder. Record dates in the Supply Inventory *(DC-06)*.

1. THE CORE KIT

✓	ITEM	WHAT TO LOOK FOR	HAVE / NEED
	Water	1 gallon per person per day, 2 weeks if you can. *(TL-02)*	
	Food	2 weeks that needs no refrigeration. *(TL-02)* Manual can opener.	
	Radio	Battery or hand-crank, with NOAA Weather Radio and alert tone.	
	Flashlights and headlamps	One per person. LED; uses the same battery size as your other gear.	
	Lanterns	Battery LED lanterns for rooms. Safer than candles.	
	Batteries	Spares for every device. Lithium AA/AAA last longest in storage and in cold.	
	Phone power	Power banks, charging cables, a car charger. *(TR-07)*	
	First-aid kit	A complete kit plus a manual. *(TR-05)*	
	Medications	At least a week of prescriptions; pain relievers, allergy and stomach medicine.	
	Whistle	To signal for help. Three blasts is the distress signal.	
	Dust masks	N95 respirators for smoke and dust.	
	Plastic sheeting and duct tape	To cover broken windows or seal a room.	
	Wrench or pliers	To turn off utilities. Keep it near the shutoffs.	
	Fire extinguisher	ABC-rated, on each level.	
	Local maps	Paper road maps of your area. *(TR-04)*	
	Cash	Small bills.	

2. SANITATION AND HYGIENE

☐ Heavy-duty garbage bags and twist ties.

☐ Feminine and incontinence supplies; diapers.

- ☐ A bucket with a tight lid and liner bags for an emergency toilet, plus cat litter or sawdust to cover waste.
- ☐ Toilet paper, wet wipes, hand sanitizer.
- ☐ Soap, toothbrushes and toothpaste.
- ☐ Household chlorine bleach (unscented) and a dropper. *(TR-02)*
- ☐ Disposable gloves.
- ☐ Paper plates, cups and utensils (saves water for washing).

3. WARMTH, COOKING AND TOOLS

- ☐ Sleeping bags or warm blankets for everyone.
- ☐ A change of warm clothes, hats, gloves and sturdy shoes for each person.
- ☐ A way to cook outdoors: camp stove or grill, with fuel. *(TR-06)*
- ☐ Matches in a waterproof container, and a lighter.
- ☐ Multi-tool or basic tool kit; work gloves.
- ☐ Tarp and rope or cord.
- ☐ Fire-resistant document box or waterproof pouch. *(DC-05)*
- ☐ Paper, pencils, and books, cards or games.

4. FOR YOUR HOUSEHOLD

- ☐ Infant formula, bottles, diapers, baby wipes.
- ☐ Glasses, contact lenses and solution; hearing-aid batteries.
- ☐ Backup power or a plan for medical equipment that needs electricity.
- ☐ Pet food, water, medicine, leash, carrier and vaccination records.
- ☐ Extra house and car keys.
- ☐ Anything else someone in your home can't do without: _____

(!) **DON'T TURN A KIT INTO A HAZARD.** Store fuel and propane outdoors, never in the house. Never use a generator, grill or camp stove indoors or in a garage. Use battery lights instead of candles wherever you can.

SOURCES / FURTHER REFERENCE

1. FEMA: Ready.gov: Build a Kit; Water; Food; Kit Maintenance. `ready.gov/kit`
2. American Red Cross: Survival Kit Supplies. `redcross.org`
3. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention: Avoiding Carbon Monoxide Poisoning. `cdc.gov/carbon-monoxide`

IMPORTANT: Follow manufacturer instructions for every appliance, battery and fuel. This list reflects the sources above as of November 2026.